# SHINCHAN ONLINE HACKATHON 2026

OFFICIAL PARTICIPANT PROBLEM STATEMENT

# DIGITAL DARK SPOT

AI-Assisted Information Gap Detection Platform

| | |
|---|---|
| Project category | Web Development • Artificial Intelligence • Research & Information Technology |
| Participation type | Individual participation |
| Suggested level | Intermediate |

## 1. Problem Statement

People rely on online information to make important decisions about education, careers, public services, research, and business. However, relevant information is often scattered across multiple websites and documents. Some sources may be outdated, different sources may provide conflicting details, and important questions may remain unanswered.

Most search tools help users find information, while summarization tools condense the information that is available. But users may still not know what is missing, what needs to be checked, or whether the information they found is complete enough to support a decision. For example, someone researching a scholarship may find eligibility criteria but miss renewal conditions, required documents, the current deadline, or the official application process.

**Challenge: Design and build a web-based platform that analyzes information from multiple sources about a topic and helps users identify potential information gaps, conflicting claims, outdated details, and unanswered questions. The platform should present evidence with source references and guide users on what to verify next.**

## 2. Expected Outcomes

- A working web application where a user can enter a topic, question, or research goal.
- A way to add or collect relevant source material, such as user-provided URLs or permitted search results.
- A structured summary of key information found across the selected sources.
- A clear list of potential information gaps and unanswered questions.
- Identification of possible contradictions between sources, with references to the relevant material.
- Warnings for potentially outdated or undated information when source dates are available.
- A prioritized checklist of items the user should verify next.
- A clear dashboard that distinguishes sourced information from AI-generated suggestions and uncertainty.

## 3. Example Use Case

Scenario: A student wants to apply for a scholarship and enters: “What should I verify before applying for this scholarship?”

- The platform reviews relevant sources, including an official scholarship page and other information pages.
- It identifies that eligibility details are available, but renewal conditions are not clearly covered in the sources reviewed.
- It notices that two sources appear to list different document requirements and shows both references.
- It flags a page that refers to an earlier application cycle, if its date or cycle information is visible.
- It creates a checklist asking the student to confirm the current deadline, official document list, renewal policy, and application link from the official source.

Illustrative output: “Potential gap: renewal requirements not found in the sources reviewed. Possible conflict: two sources list different income documents. Verify using the latest official scholarship notice.”

## 4. Participant Submission Requirements

All submissions must be made through Unista, using the same account with which you registered for the hackathon. Open the Rounds section and use the project submission button when it becomes available.

| | |
|---|---|
| Submission opens | 31 October 2026 • 10:00 AM |
| Submission deadline | 1 November 2026 • 5:00 PM |
| Available submission window | 31 hours |

Required fields

- Project name — Mandatory: Name of your project.
- Project description — Mandatory: Explain the problem, proposed solution, how the project works, all major features, uniqueness/innovation, technology stack, and future scope. Make this detailed, clear, and professional so judges can understand the project.
- GitHub repository link — Mandatory: Provide an accessible repository containing your source code. Include a README or setup instructions where possible.

Optional fields

- Live demo link: Add the URL if your project is deployed. Deployment is not compulsory.
- Demo video link: Optional walkthrough showing the project and its main features.
- PPT / presentation: Optional presentation file.

**The project description and GitHub repository link are mandatory. A live deployment, demo video, and PPT are not mandatory. Check that your repository permissions allow judges to access your code.**

## 5. Judging Criteria — Total 10 Marks

Judges will score each submission out of 10 using the following weighted criteria:

| Evaluation area | What will be evaluated | Weight | Marks |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Problem understanding & relevance** | Understanding of the information-gap problem, target users, and real-world usefulness. | 15% | **1.5** |
| **Innovation & originality** | How meaningfully the idea goes beyond ordinary search, summarization, or chatbot features. | 20% | **2.0** |
| **Working prototype & functionality** | Core workflow works: input, source review, gap findings, and next-step checklist. | 25% | **2.5** |
| **Technical implementation** | Web development quality, data handling, AI integration if used, and reliability. | 15% | **1.5** |
| **Evidence, accuracy & transparency** | Findings are traceable to sources; uncertainty and possible errors are communicated responsibly. | 15% | **1.5** |
| **Presentation & demo** | Clarity, usability, realistic demonstration, and answers to judges' questions. | 10% | **1.0** |
| **TOTAL** | | **100%** | **10.0** |

## 6. Judging Guidance

- A working, polished core feature is more valuable than many incomplete features.
- Participants should demonstrate the project using real or clearly identified sample sources.
- AI-generated findings must be labelled as potential gaps or signals, not guaranteed facts.
- Judges should be able to inspect source references behind important findings.
- A generic chatbot or AI summary alone does not satisfy the challenge; the information-gap detection workflow must be demonstrated.

## 7. Suggested Demo Flow

Enter one research question, add or retrieve several sources, show the extracted information, demonstrate at least one potential gap or possible conflict, open the supporting source references, and generate a checklist of what the user should verify next.

All the best to every participant. Build thoughtfully, verify your evidence, and make your solution useful.